RMIT GAME JAM CONCEPT PITCH

Project Delivery: Apartment 404

Team: Bit'em

Platform: PC | Target: Ages 16+

GAME OVERVIEW & ATTRIBUTES

GENRE	VISUAL STYLE	TONE & REFERENCES	CORE DILEMMA
Psychological Horror / RPG / Detective	**Eccentric 2D Horror (POV Angle)**	**Sally Face, Do Not Feed the Monkeys**	**Corporate Greed vs. Moral Intervention**

GAMEPLAY ARCHITECTURE

1. Order Intake — Receive route & delivery task → **2. Doorstep Action** — Deliver item & collect intel → **3. Shift Dossier** — File report to dispatcher → **4. Compensation** — Collect pay or dark bonus

01. GROUND IMMERSION
Step directly into the shoes of a gig courier navigating a derelict tenement housing block.

02. TENANT ENGAGEMENT
Converse with tenants across dynamic dialogues to uncover hidden clues and lore fragments.

03. BRANCHING DECISIONS
Decide whether to truthfully report, doctor surveillance forms, or protect vulnerable residents.

NARRATIVE PREMISE & CORE INSIGHT

A desperate young job seeker accepts employment at a shady courier agency. His single operational sector is an isolated, decaying inner-city tenement building exuding an oppressive dread. Initially routine, deliveries grow increasingly unnerving until he overhears disturbing sounds behind sealed doors at night.

Instead of reassurance, management instructs him to actively spy on designated residents for lucrative cash bonuses under absolute confidentiality. Parallels swiftly emerge between delivery manifests, past murders in Room 202/404, and vanished children. Shockingly, the surveillance dossiers he files appear to actively warp the apartment environment itself.

The player must navigate between blind corporate servitude, independent detective work, or finding a way to escape before becoming an archived subject.

LOGLINE & THEMATIC FOUNDATION

Premise: Delivering parcels to a haunted apartment complex, a courier discovers paranormal events tied to peculiar orders, forced to choose between corporate espionage bonuses and uncovering an unsolved child abuse case.

Social Insight: Highlights physical and psychological adolescent bullying (ages 15–18) driven by distorted behaviors that fall through the cracks of formal legal intervention.

SEVEN-DAY INVESTIGATION TIMELINE (LINEAR PROGRESSION)

Monday: Orientation
Rules & Insinuations

Security Guard:	Sets strict delivery mandate: parcels must reach unit doors directly.
Grocery Lady:	Insinuates haunted activity tied to Unit 404.
Rollers Lady:	Heaps excessive praise on the model honor student.
Fortune Teller:	Warns of impending omens surrounding Room 404.
Couple & Student:	High praise for student; first encounter with the honor boy.

Tuesday: Discord
Tensions Rise

Attractive Lady:	Spreads uneasy supernatural warnings about Unit 404.
Alcoholic Man:	Bitter disdain for delinquent student; hears corridor noises.
Elderly Couple:	Defend the delinquent boy against neighborhood slander.
Chubby Lady:	Praises honor student; notes the guard's routine.
Street Thug:	Delivers crucial leads enabling investigation of the 4th floor.

Wednesday: The Parcel
Suspicious Link

Delinquent:	Receives a suspicious package sent directly by the honor student.
Sick Student:	Impoverished tenant vouches for the delinquent boy.
Alcoholic Man:	Visibly paranoid and hostile; identifies noise inside 404.
Landlord:	Routine interaction with escalating building tensions.

Thursday: Surveillance
Alcoholic Disappears

Technician:	CCTV installation team queries building layout.
Grocery Lady:	Fabricates ghost rumors regarding closed Unit 202.
Honor Student:	Probes suspiciously about delinquent student's state.
Delinquent:	Notices overt signs of tracking and psychological abuse.
Fortune Teller:	Unveils historical murder/abuse case from Room 202.

Friday: Escalation
Impending Threat

Rollers Lady:	Reports rhythmic thuds overhead recurring every alternate day.
Honor's Mother:	Defensive encounter; answers why son hides from deliveries.
Couple:	Pack belongings; plan desperate relocation out of pure terror.
Street Thug:	Secondary critical interaction regarding tenement secrets.

Saturday & Sunday: The Heist
Diversion & Climax

Lure Chain:	Grocery lady reveals guard's sweet tooth $\rightarrow$ Chubby lady bakes pastries $\rightarrow$ Elderly couple provide ingredients $\rightarrow$ Guard drawn away from post.
Fortune Teller:	Foretells imminent death before nightfall.
Sunday:	Path branch execution; outcome revealed based on choices.

BRANCHING ENDINGS MATRIX

BAD ENDING: SILENCED
Condition: Player submits false/careless reports consistently (e.g. checking a single column 3 times).
Outcome: The agency determines the courier is a liability. The courier is permanently eliminated.

GOOD ENDING: JUSTICE SERVED
Condition: Balanced shift reports (half-true, half-false) combined with collected evidence sent to Child Protection.
Outcome: Abuse network broken; delinquent student is rescued and protected.

RICH ENDING: CORRUPTED
Condition: Obey company mandates completely for maximum payout, failing to rescue the delinquent student.
Outcome: Promoted to senior corrupt operative; ethical boundaries erased for wealth.

MECHANICAL CONSTRAINTS & BRANCHING RULES

- **Repetition Trap:** Marking identical checkbox parameters 3 times consecutively guarantees the Bad Ending trigger.
- **Resolution Threshold:** Unlocking the Good Ending strictly requires evidence submission to Child Protective Services in addition to strategic reporting.
- **Failure to Intervene:** If the delinquent youth is not saved by Sunday night, the game defaults to the Rich Ending or Bad Ending regardless of player intent.